what counties are in the most need of food banks relative to population and number of grocery stores available

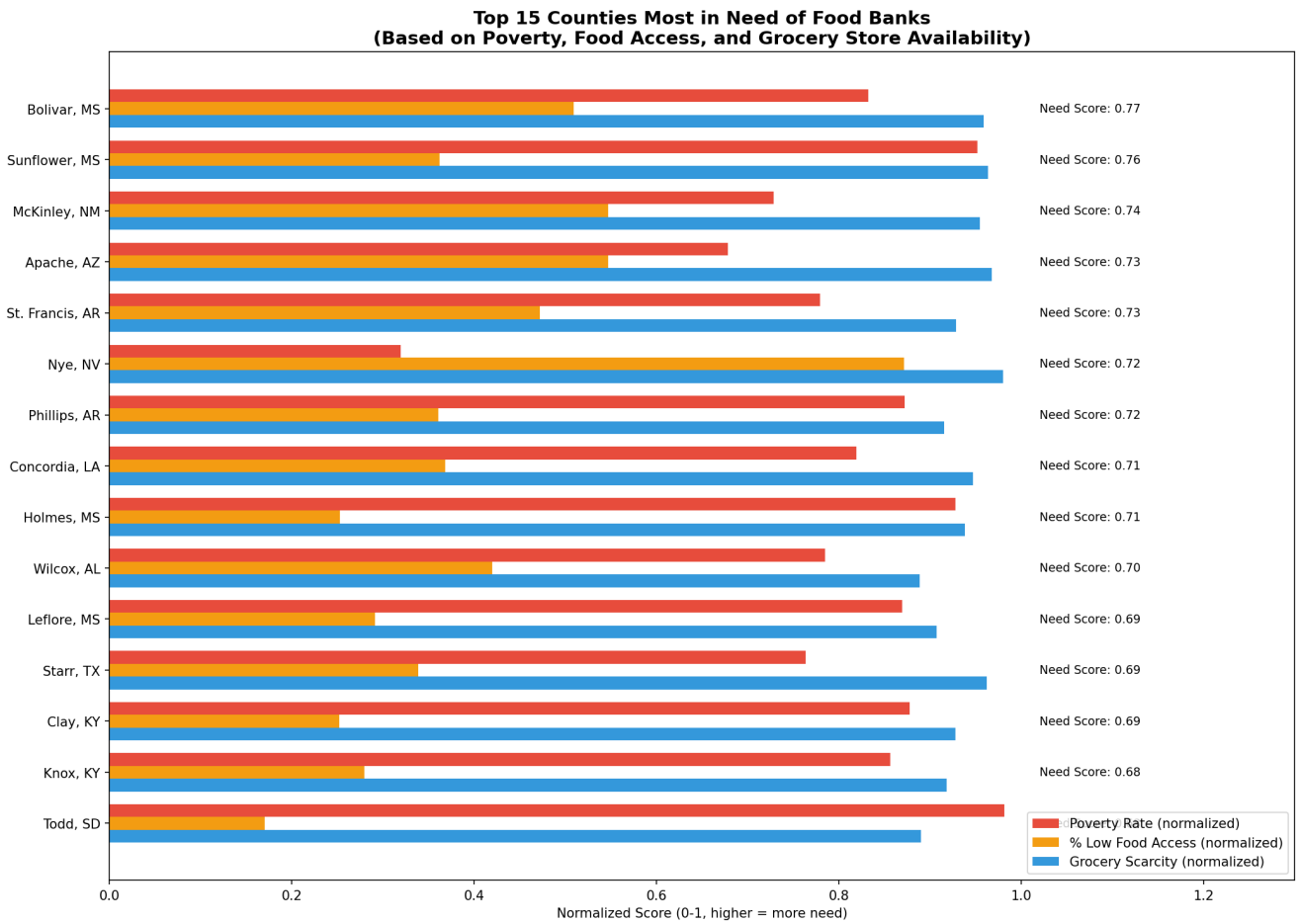
The counties most in need of food banks relative to population and grocery store availability were identified using a composite need score based on three factors: poverty rate, percentage of population with low food access, and grocery store scarcity (inverse of grocery stores per 1,000 population).

Top 15 Counties Most in Need of Food Banks:

1. Bolivar County, MS - 34.2% poverty, 50.9% low food access, 0.13 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
2. Sunflower County, MS - 38.7% poverty, 36.2% low food access, 0.12 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
3. McKinley County, NM - 30.3% poverty, 54.7% low food access, 0.14 grocery stores per 1k, 1 food bank
4. Apache County, AZ - 28.4% poverty, 54.7% low food access, 0.11 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
5. St. Francis County, AR - 32.2% poverty, 47.2% low food access, 0.20 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
6. Nye County, NV - 14.9% poverty, 87.1% low food access, 0.08 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
7. Phillips County, AR - 35.7% poverty, 36.1% low food access, 0.23 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
8. Concordia Parish, LA - 33.7% poverty, 36.8% low food access, 0.16 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
9. Holmes County, MS - 37.8% poverty, 25.3% low food access, 0.18 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
10. Wilcox County, AL - 32.4% poverty, 42.0% low food access, 0.29 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
11. Leflore County, MS - 35.6% poverty, 29.1% low food access, 0.25 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
12. Starr County, TX - 31.6% poverty, 33.9% low food access, 0.12 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
13. Clay County, KY - 35.9% poverty, 25.2% low food access, 0.20 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
14. Knox County, KY - 35.1% poverty, 27.9% low food access, 0.23 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks
15. Todd County, SD - 39.8% poverty, 17.0% low food access, 0.29 grocery stores per 1k, 0 food banks

Key findings:
- Mississippi has the most counties in the top 15 (5 counties)
- 14 of the top 15 counties have zero food banks
- Most counties have fewer than 0.30 grocery stores per 1,000 population (national average is around 0.20)
- All top counties have poverty rates above 25%, with some exceeding 35%
- These counties are concentrated in the Mississippi Delta, Appalachian Kentucky, the Southwest

(Native American reservations), and the Texas-Mexico border region



Top 15 Counties Most in Need of Food Banks
(Ranked by Composite Need Score: Poverty + Low Food Access + Grocery Scarcity)

Rank	County, State	Poverty Rate	% Low Food Access	Grocery Stores per 1k Pop	Food Banks	Need Score
1	Bolivar, MS	34.2%	50.9%	0.13	0	0.767
2	Sunflower, MS	38.7%	36.2%	0.12	0	0.759
3	McKinley, NM	30.3%	54.7%	0.14	1	0.744
4	Apache, AZ	28.4%	54.7%	0.11	0	0.731
5	St. Francis, AR	32.2%	47.2%	0.20	0	0.727
6	Nye, NV	14.9%	87.1%	0.08	0	0.724
7	Phillips, AR	35.7%	36.1%	0.23	0	0.716
8	Concordia, LA	33.7%	36.8%	0.16	0	0.712
9	Holmes, MS	37.8%	25.3%	0.18	0	0.707
10	Wilcox, AL	32.4%	42.0%	0.29	0	0.698
11	Leflore, MS	35.6%	29.1%	0.25	0	0.689
12	Starr, TX	31.6%	33.9%	0.12	0	0.688
13	Clay, KY	35.9%	25.2%	0.20	0	0.686
14	Knox, KY	35.1%	27.9%	0.23	0	0.685
15	Todd, SD	39.8%	17.0%	0.29	0	0.681